



IS THIS SAFE?

You washed your hands with soap and water for 20 seconds before preparing a salad with fresh fruits and vegetables, rinsed all produce well under running water, and kept the salad refrigerated below 40°F until serving.



IS THIS SAFE?

You left cooked chicken salad out on the picnic table in summer heat (about 85°F) for 4 hours before serving it to your friends.



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned green beans using a boiling water bath canner because you added lemon juice to make them slightly acidic.



IS THIS SAFE?

Jamie is canning fresh peaches using a boiling water canner. She selects ripe, firm peaches, washes them thoroughly, and packs them into hot, sterilized jars. Jamie follows a tested recipe, adding the recommended amount of lemon juice for acidity and processes the jars for the exact time specified to ensure safety.



IS THIS SAFE?

Alex decides to can fresh strawberries but uses old lids he found in the back of the cupboard. He did not wash the jars or lids, skipped preheating the jars, and processed the jars for less time than recommended in the recipe.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

Sara wants to can blueberries using a boiling water canner but didn't add any lemon juice or other acid. She wonders if her canned blueberries will be safe since they are naturally sweet and have some acidity.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned a batch of salsa following a tested recipe exactly, using bottled 5% white vinegar for acidity and processed the jars in a boiling water canner for the recommended time.

CANNING TOMATOES & SALSAS

Teens (14-18)

CT-T02



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned fresh tomatoes without adding any lemon juice or citric acid, and processed the jars in a boiling water canner only for 20 minutes.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to add fresh garlic and extra thickening with tomato paste before canning your salsa in a boiling water canner.



IS THIS SAFE?

You just finished pressure canning green beans following the exact USDA-approved recipe with the right pressure and time. The jars sealed properly and you cooled the canner naturally before removing the food.



IS THIS SAFE?

Someone packed quart jars very full with cooked ground beef, skipped the 10 minute venting step on the pressure canner, and then canned at home using a boiling water bath instead of a pressure canner.

LOW ACID FOODS

Teens (14-18)

LA-T03



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to store cooked low acid vegetables like green beans in quart jars but are unsure if you should pressure can or freeze them first.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T01



IS THIS SAFE?

You followed a tested quick-pickle recipe that uses vinegar with 5% acidity and fresh vegetables. You kept the jars in the refrigerator and ate them within a few weeks.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T02



IS THIS SAFE?

A friend decided to make pickles using homemade vinegar with unknown acidity, reducing the vinegar amount and doubling the water, then canned the pickles without processing.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T03



IS THIS SAFE?

You make fermented pickles by packing cucumbers into a jar with salt brine and leaving them at room temperature to ferment. You wonder if it is safe to eat after 1 day.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You make strawberry freezer jam using a tested recipe that calls for mashing fresh strawberries with added sugar and then pouring the mixture into clean containers. You store it promptly in the freezer and only take out small amounts to eat within a few weeks.



IS THIS SAFE?

You try to make jelly at home but decide to reduce the sugar way below the recipe's recommendation without using any special low-sugar pectin. You cook the jelly and can it in jars using a water bath canner.



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to make elderberry jam and find a recipe online. The recipe uses American elderberries and calls for a high ratio of sugar to berry pulp, but you consider lowering the sugar amount to make it healthier.



IS THIS SAFE?

You froze a batch of homemade vegetable soup in clean, airtight containers. The freezer temperature is kept steady at 0°F (-18°C) or below. You always check the freezer thermometer regularly.



IS THIS SAFE?

You left a stuffed turkey breast in the freezer, but the power went out for about 3 days. You opened the freezer a few times during that time to check the food. Some turkey looks partially thawed and soft.



IS THIS SAFE?

You froze fresh fish you caught the same day, but you didn't ice the fish immediately-you froze it right after cleaning. Now you wonder if it's safe to eat after freezing.



IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare beef jerky by slicing lean meat, marinate it in the refrigerator for 8 hours, then dehydrate it until dry. After drying, you heat the jerky in an oven at 275°F for 10 minutes before storing it at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

You hot-smoke fish by placing it in a smoker at 90°F, keeping it there for several hours without adding salt or cooking it to a higher temperature, then storing it at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

You dry sliced apricots in a dehydrator. You wonder if it's safe to eat them without treating them first since apricots are low-acid fruits. You consider just drying them or pretreating with lemon juice or another acid.